

PMPG Payment Insights – September 2026

ISO 2022 Update | A Longer Runway, the Same Destination

More Time. Better Data. Measurable Progress.

The revised implementation timeline provides parts of the payments ecosystem with additional time to complete the transition from fully unstructured to hybrid and fully structured postal addresses. Other Payment Market Infrastructures are expected to continue with planned implementation activities in November 2026.

The target state and the responsibility to deliver it remain unchanged. Richer, hybrid and structured postal address information (already supported) remains fundamental to interoperability, effective compliance processes and scalable automation.

Institutions should reassess their exposure across payment systems, recalibrate implementation priorities and maintain readiness for Infrastructures proceeding in November 2026. Any additional time available elsewhere should be used to accelerate data remediation, expand testing and deliver measurable improvements in data quality and implementation readiness.

Different timelines require sharper prioritisation, not reduced momentum.



Recalibrating Priorities

As implementation timelines diverge, Institutions should review their payment flows and dependencies across relevant Market Infrastructures. Testing and readiness activities should be prioritised according to the requirements that will apply in each payment ecosystem, with particular attention to Infrastructures proceeding with **changes in November 2026**.

Where additional time is available, it should be used to address the readiness challenges that led to the extension request, including customer data remediation, operational preparedness, end-to-end testing and ecosystem alignment.

Additional time only creates value if it is used to improve readiness. The objective is to convert the extension into measurable progress.



Demonstrating Progress

The decision to provide additional implementation time reflects the reality that readiness across the ecosystem remains uneven.

As the industry progresses towards the target state, attention is expected to focus on measurable outcomes, including production adoption, testing progress, data remediation and the reduction of temporary workarounds. The availability of additional implementation time should be reflected in demonstrable progress across these areas.

This is consistent with broader regulatory and industry expectations that structured data adoption ultimately delivers tangible improvements in interoperability, compliance and processing efficiency.

Additional implementation time should be reflected in measurable improvements to data quality. Progress is best demonstrated by implementation outcomes rather than implementation plans.



What Good Looks Like (in Practice)

- Continue customer and counterparty data remediation programmes.
- Maintain testing and readiness activities already underway.
- Communicate clearly and consistently with customers regarding ongoing expectations.
- Understand dependencies across payment channels, Market Infrastructures and correspondent relationships.

Result: Reduced implementation risk, improved customer transparency and greater interoperability across payment ecosystems.



Interoperability Considerations During the Transition

Consideration #1: Differing PMI Implementation Approaches

As implementation timelines evolve across parts of the payments ecosystem, Institutions should review whether current testing, implementation plans and client communication remain aligned with the payment systems they support.

While the implementation timeline for CBPR+ payment messages has been revised, some Payment Market Infrastructures are expected to continue with planned implementation activities aligned with HVPS+ UG2026 and related market requirements, potentially resulting in different implementation timelines and requirements across payment ecosystems.

As a result, Institutions should identify and address any interoperability implications arising from different implementation timelines, requirements and transition approaches across the end-to-end payment chain.

Consideration #2: Placeholder Usage

With implementation timelines evolving, Institutions may wish to revisit any temporary placeholder strategies that had been considered specifically to support November 2026 transition activities.

As set out in PMPG guidance, placeholders do not improve underlying data quality and should not be viewed as a permanent solution. Additional implementation time should support source data remediation and the collection of meaningful structured information rather than increasing reliance on temporary workarounds.

Workarounds may support transition planning. They are a temporary substitute for underlying data remediation.

Consideration #3: Customer Readiness and Data Availability

Where Payment Market Infrastructures continue with planned November 2026 implementation activities, Institutions need to maintain or accelerate readiness efforts for in scope payment flows, irrespective of changes elsewhere in the ecosystem.

Particular attention should be given to customer communication, **data-remediation activities and the collection of target-state hybrid and structured postal address information** for payment flows subject to November 2026 requirements.

Institutions should assess:

- which payment systems and customer populations remain subject to November 2026 implementation requirements;
- whether customer communication plans remain aligned to those requirements;
- whether additional outreach is required to support the provision of structured or hybrid postal address data; and
- whether operational processes adequately support the identification and management of affected payment flows.

Temporary workarounds may support continuity. Long-term interoperability depends on the availability of meaningful structured data across the payment chain.

Consideration #4: Supporting Data Elements

Beyond postal address requirements, several SR2026 changes aim to improve the consistent interpretation and processing of data across payment ecosystems. During the period where payment systems may follow different implementation timelines, Institutions should assess whether certain supporting data elements

can be sourced, populated and retained consistently across the end-to-end payment chain. Relevant examples include:

- **Instructed Amount (CR 003013):** Some PMIs may mandate the Instructed Amount to be populated consistently across the payment and return chain (pacs.008, pacs.009COV, pacs.004).
- **Proxy Type (CR 003012):** Where a Proxy Identifier is used to identify an account, the corresponding Proxy Type may also be required.
- **Scheme Name (CR 003031):** Where Other Identification is used for the identification of a party, the corresponding Scheme Name may be required and restricted to recognised code values (ISO External Code List).
- **Creditor Reference (CR 000068):** Where Creditor Reference Information is used, the associated Reference may become mandatory.
- **Branch Identification (CR 000042):** SR2026 removed the use of Branch Identification in favour of more consistent identification approaches.

While the use of Proxy Identifiers remains relatively limited in many high-value payment environments, the use of Other Identification without the corresponding Scheme Name continues to be observed and may affect the consistent interpretation of party information across payment ecosystems.

Practical Considerations to Reduce Interoperability Friction

To minimise interoperability challenges during the transition period, Institutions should consider:

- populating the **Instructed Amount** by default
- providing the corresponding **Proxy Type** whenever a Proxy Identifier is used
- providing the corresponding **Scheme Name** whenever Other Identification is used
- ensuring a **Reference** is included whenever Creditor Reference Information is populated
- avoiding unnecessary reliance on **Branch Identification**

Interoperability depends not only on the data itself, but also on the consistent provision of the information required to interpret it.

Beyond Postal Addresses

The revised implementation timeline extends beyond postal address requirements. Institutions should also consider the implications for related migration activities, including exceptions and investigations (E&I), payment initiation migration and associated FINplus adoption milestones.

Managing the Transition

As the transition progresses across the payments ecosystem, Institutions will need to understand the practical implications for end-to-end payment flows.

The PMPG will continue to support the industry through market practice discussions focused on interoperability, transition scenarios and the practical challenges arising from differing implementation approaches. In parallel, the PMPG and HVPS+ are engaging with PMIs and industry stakeholders to improve understanding of implementation approaches and their potential interoperability implications across payment ecosystems.

PMPG has also published an accompanying overview of currently known PMI implementation approaches and postal-address requirements following the SR2026 timeline revision. Developed with the support of HVPS+ and Swift, the overview provides a point-in-time reference and will be updated as further confirmed information becomes available.

Sources/Related Documents:

Swift: [Knowledge Centre](#)

PMPG: [Swift Payments Market Practice Group document center](#) | [Swift](#)

Looking ahead

 **October 2026: Interoperability in Practice**

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